DCTVU

DC TELEVISION UNIVERSE

Franchise Bible — Volume 02: The Broadcast Home

FORMAT • TONE • CONTINUITY • CANON • TEAMS & FOUNDING ROSTERS

An alternate-history story told through Hollywood trades, headlines,
social media, the internet, and screenplay-format scenes.

Story present: 2010.
Six live-action series + two animated series. One multiverse.

Internal development document. Fictional actors and the individual series to be created in later volumes.

Section 1 — The Recommendation

LIVE-ACTION (6 series): THE CW | ANIMATION (2 series): CARTOON NETWORK
Both are Time Warner networks, which puts the entire DCTVU under one corporate roof: **Warner Bros. Television** produces it, **DC Entertainment** guards the canon, and Warner-owned outlets air all of it.

Why The CW is the right home for the live-action series

- **Warner Bros. co-owns it.** The CW is a 50/50 joint venture of Warner Bros. Entertainment and CBS Corporation. No other broadcast network lets Warner control the scheduling, the episode orders, the crossover nights, and the long-term plan for a six-show universe. A big-four network (ABC, CBS, NBC, FOX) would make the franchise a guest in someone else's house.
- **It already has a DC home.** *Smallville* moved from The WB to The CW in 2006 and is entering its tenth and final season in fall 2010. The DCTVU inherits Smallville's audience, time slot, crews, Vancouver production base, and visual-effects pipeline. It is the most natural handoff in television.
- **The 22-episode classic season.** The CW orders full 22-episode network seasons for its dramas, which matches our locked format exactly. Cable networks in 2010 usually order 10 to 13.
- **A built-in reason to say yes.** In 2010 The CW is a young network, mid-tier in reach and narrow in demographic, and it needs a brand. Six interconnected DC series give it an identity overnight. That urgency is the network's motive, and it is also great drama for our story.
- **Crossovers stay in-house.** All six shows on one network means a crossover is one press release, one promo campaign, and one event week. Crossing over between rival networks is practically impossible.

Why Cartoon Network is the right home for the animated series

- **Sibling network under Turner Broadcasting (Time Warner).** Warner Bros. Animation and DC already have a pipeline there: *Batman: The Brave and the Bold* is on the air, and DC animation has a long Cartoon Network history.
- **A Friday night prime-time block.** Animation is canon in the DCTVU, so it gets a real prime-time slot, not a Saturday-morning slot.
- **A 26-episode order** is standard for the channel's action-animation, which matches our locked format.

Honest tradeoff: Cartoon Network keeps most of its original action series at TV-PG/TV-Y7-FV. Holding the animated DCTVU series to the locked **TV-14** rating will mean a fight with Standards & Practices. Winning the first prime-time TV-14 block for a DC animated series is a strong storyline for our 2010 trades.

Section 2 — The Alternatives Considered

Outlet	Upside	Why it loses
NBC / ABC / CBS / FOX	Biggest reach, biggest budgets	Warner owns none of them. Six shows split across rival networks kills crossovers, and big-four networks cancel quickly on low ratings.
TNT / TBS (Turner)	Time Warner owned, adult audience, cable freedom	2010 cable drama orders run 10–13 episodes, which breaks our 22-episode classic format. Also smaller reach than broadcast.
Split model (some CW, some big four)	Hedges risk	Shatters continuity control. The Story Group can't enforce one timeline across competing networks.
Adult Swim (animation)	Easy TV-14 and up	Late-night block; it ghettoizes the animated series and loses the family and young-fan audience.

Section 3 — The Prime-Time Grid

In 2010 The CW programs **two prime-time hours, Monday through Friday** (8:00–10:00 PM ET/PT). Six DCTVU hours would take **six of its ten weekly prime-time hours**. The series names are placeholders until you create them.

Night	8:00 PM ET/PT	9:00 PM ET/PT
Monday	DCTVU Series 1	Existing CW drama
Tuesday	DCTVU Series 2	DCTVU Series 3 (paired lead-in)
Wednesday	Existing CW programming	DCTVU Series 4
Thursday	DCTVU Series 5	Existing CW drama
Friday	DCTVU Series 6 (Smallville's old slot)	Existing CW drama
Friday (Cartoon Network)	DCTVU Animated 1 (7:00 PM)	DCTVU Animated 2 (7:30 PM)

Crossover weeks: every series involved airs its part in the same week, and the story moves night to night like a comic-book event, so each night is a chapter. Animated series tie in the same Friday.

Rollout realism: a network can't launch six dramas at once. The realistic path is a staggered rollout over several seasons, starting with flagship series and adding more each year until the full slate is on air. We'll work out the exact phasing once you create the series.

Section 4 — Risks the Story Can Play With

- **CBS, the co-owner,** has its own say in The CW's schedule and may push back on one studio controlling 60% of prime time.
- **Affiliate and advertiser doubts:** The CW's audience skews young and female in 2010, so a superhero slate is a deliberate repositioning that sparks skepticism in the trades.
- **Budget pressure:** an unnerfed, comic-accurate universe is expensive, and The CW's license fees are lower than the big four's. Warner Bros. TV deficit-finances the franchise and bets on international sales, DVD/Blu-ray, iTunes, and syndication.
- **Fan reaction:** early-2010s message boards and Twitter ask whether “the Gossip Girl network” can handle the Justice League.